INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY DHARWAD

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Course: Software Systems Laboratory (CS202C)



PROJECT REPORT

Student Performance Analytics & Prediction System

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November 2026

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Chapter 1

Abstract

The Student Performance Analytics & Prediction System is a Python-based application developed to analyse student academic performance and estimate grades using historical academic records. The system processes student information from CSV datasets, performs statistical analysis, and generates visualizations to identify patterns and trends in academic performance.

The prediction component uses historical student performance and corresponding awarded grades to establish a relationship between relative academic performance and grades. A statistical normalization technique based on Z-scores is employed to measure the relative performance of students within their respective batches. The resulting relationship is then used to estimate grades for students in the current batch.

In addition to grade prediction, the application provides statistical summaries and graphical representations of student marks, grades, and attendance. The effectiveness of the prediction approach is evaluated using historical data by comparing estimated grades against actual grades.

The project combines statistical analysis, data processing, object-oriented programming, and data visualization to develop an integrated system for academic performance analysis and grade estimation.

Chapter 2

Introduction

2.1 Background

Academic performance analysis involves examining student records to understand performance patterns, identify trends, and evaluate academic outcomes. Student marks, attendance, assignments, and examination results provide useful information for understanding academic performance.

However, directly comparing marks obtained by students from different batches may not always provide a meaningful comparison. Differences in examination difficulty, evaluation patterns, and overall batch performance can influence the marks obtained by students.

Statistical techniques can help address this issue by expressing individual performance relative to the overall performance of a batch. Such an approach provides a better understanding of a student's position within their academic group rather than considering marks in isolation.

2.2 Motivation

The motivation behind this project is to develop a system that combines academic performance analysis with statistical grade prediction.

Traditional academic records provide information about marks and grades, but extracting meaningful patterns from these records often requires additional statistical processing and visualization.

Furthermore, estimating grades for a current batch using historical academic records presents an interesting statistical problem. Historical data contains both student performance information and the grades awarded to students. By analysing the relationship between these two aspects, it may be possible to estimate the likely grades of students whose final grades are not yet available.

The project therefore aims to automate the analysis process and explore the use of relative academic performance as a basis for grade estimation.

2.3 Project Overview

The application consists of two major functional components.

The first component performs statistical analysis and visualization. It imports academic records from CSV files, processes the data, calculates statistical summaries, and generates graphical representations of student performance.

The second component performs grade prediction. It uses historical academic records containing actual grades to establish a relationship between relative performance and awarded grades. This relationship is subsequently applied to the current batch to estimate student grades.

Together, these components provide an integrated environment for analysing academic performance and exploring historical-data-based grade prediction.

Chapter 3

Problem Statement and Objectives

3.1 Problem Statement

The objective of this project is to develop a system capable of analysing student academic performance and estimating grades for a current batch using historical academic records.

The historical dataset contains student performance information along with the actual grades awarded, whereas the current batch dataset contains available academic information without the final grades.

The challenge is to identify a meaningful relationship between students' relative academic performance and their awarded grades in historical data, and use this relationship to estimate grades for the current batch.

The system must also provide statistical summaries and visualizations that help understand the underlying academic performance patterns.

3.2 Objectives

The primary objectives of the project are:

1. To import and process academic records stored in CSV files.
2. To clean and prepare student datasets for statistical analysis.
3. To calculate statistical measures that describe student performance.
4. To analyse marks, grades, and attendance using appropriate visualizations.
5. To calculate relative student performance using statistical normalization.
6. To establish a relationship between historical relative performance and awarded grades.
7. To estimate grades for students in the current batch using historical information.

Chapter 4

Data Preprocessing

Data preprocessing is an important stage of the application because the quality and consistency of the input data directly influence subsequent statistical calculations and predictions.

Before performing analysis, the input datasets are loaded and prepared for processing.

4.1 Data Loading

The application accepts student academic records in CSV format. The datasets are imported using Python data-processing libraries.

The historical dataset contains academic performance information along with actual grades. The current batch dataset contains available student information that is used for statistical analysis and grade estimation.

After loading, the datasets are examined to verify that the required columns are available and that the data can be processed correctly.

4.2 Data Cleaning

Data cleaning is performed to identify and handle inconsistencies that may affect statistical calculations.

The preprocessing stage considers the following aspects:

- Identification of missing values in relevant columns.
- Detection of duplicate roll numbers.
- Removing extra spaces in student name.
- Ensuring that the records used for analysis contain the required information.

4.3 Data Transformation

After cleaning, the relevant attributes are converted into suitable formats for statistical analysis.

Numerical attributes such as examination marks and attendance are prepared for mathematical calculations. The historical grade information is also organized into a form suitable for establishing the relationship between relative performance and awarded grades.

The resulting processed datasets are then passed to the statistical analysis and prediction components.

Chapter 5

Proposed Methodology

5.1 Overview of the Proposed Approach

The proposed approach is based on analysing student performance relative to the overall performance of their batch.

Instead of considering examination marks independently, the system uses statistical normalization to determine how far an individual student's performance lies from the batch average.

Historical student records are used to establish the relationship between relative performance and awarded grades. The resulting grade mapping is then applied to the current batch to estimate grades.

The overall methodology consists of the following stages:

1. Load and preprocess historical academic data.
2. Calculate the mean and standard deviation of the relevant performance measure.
3. Calculate the Z-score of each historical student.
4. Associate historical Z-scores with their actual grades.
5. Establish a representative Z-score for each grade.
6. Calculate Z-scores for students in the current batch.
7. Estimate grades by comparing current student Z-scores with historical grade-level Z-scores.

5.2 Statistical Foundation

The proposed methodology uses the mean and standard deviation to understand the distribution of student performance.

The arithmetic mean represents the average performance of a batch and is calculated as:

$$\mu = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^{N} X_i \tag{5.1}$$

where:

- N represents the number of students.
- X_i represents the performance value of the i-th student.
- μ represents the average performance.

Standard deviation measures the dispersion of student performance around the mean. It is calculated as:

$$\sigma = \sqrt{\frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^{N} (X_i - \mu)^2} \tag{5.2}$$

The standard deviation provides information about how closely student performance is concentrated around the average.

These statistical measures form the basis for calculating the relative performance of individual students.

5.3 Z-score Calculation

The Z-score is a statistical measure that indicates how far a particular observation lies from the mean in terms of standard deviations.

It is calculated using:

$$Z_i = \frac{X_i - \mu}{\sigma} \tag{5.3}$$

where:

- X_i is the performance value of the student.
- μ is the mean performance of the batch.
- σ is the standard deviation of the batch.
- Z_i is the relative performance score of the student.

The interpretation of the Z-score is as follows:

- A positive Z-score indicates performance above the batch average.

- A negative Z-score indicates performance below the batch average.
- A zero Z-score indicates performance equal to the batch average.

For example, a student with a Z-score of $+1$ performs one standard deviation above the batch average, whereas a student with a Z-score of -1 performs one standard deviation below it.

Thus, the Z-score provides a standardized measure of relative academic performance.

5.4 Historical Grade-to-Performance Mapping

The historical dataset contains both student performance values and their corresponding actual grades.

After calculating the Z-scores of historical students, the system groups students according to their awarded grades.

For each grade, a representative Z-score is calculated using the average Z-score of students belonging to that grade.

For a grade g, the representative Z-score is:

$$\overline{Z}_g = \frac{1}{N_g} \sum_{i=1}^{N_g} Z_i \tag{5.4}$$

where:

- N_g represents the number of students awarded grade g.
- Z_i represents the Z-score of an individual student belonging to grade g.
- $\overline{Z}_g$ represents the average Z-score associated with grade g.

This creates a mapping between historical grades and relative academic performance.

The resulting mapping acts as the reference for estimating grades in the current batch.

5.5 Current Batch Grade Estimation

Once the historical grade mapping has been established, the system calculates the Z-scores of students in the current batch.

The relative performance of each current student is then compared with the representative Z-scores associated with historical grades.

The predicted grade is assigned based on the closest representative historical Z-score.

Mathematically, the estimated grade can be expressed as:

$$\widehat{g}_i = \arg\min_{g \in G} \left| Z_i - \overline{Z}_g \right| \tag{5.5}$$

where:

- G represents the set of available historical grades.
- Z_i represents the current student's Z-score.
- $\overline{Z}_g$ represents the representative Z-score for grade g.
- $\widehat{g}_i$ represents the estimated grade.

This approach assigns a grade based on the historical grade category whose representative relative performance is closest to that of the current student.

5.6 Assumptions

The proposed methodology is based on the following assumptions:

1. Historical academic performance provides a useful reference for estimating current batch grades.
2. The relationship between relative student performance and awarded grades remains reasonably consistent across batches.
3. The statistical distributions of the historical and current batches can be compared using the adopted normalization approach.

These assumptions influence the reliability of the resulting grade estimates and should be considered when interpreting predictions.

Chapter 6

Algorithm Design

6.1 Overall Workflow

The application follows a sequence of data-processing, statistical-analysis, and prediction operations.

The historical dataset is first processed to calculate relative performance scores and establish a grade mapping. The current batch dataset is then processed using the corresponding statistical methodology, and estimated grades are generated using the historical mapping.

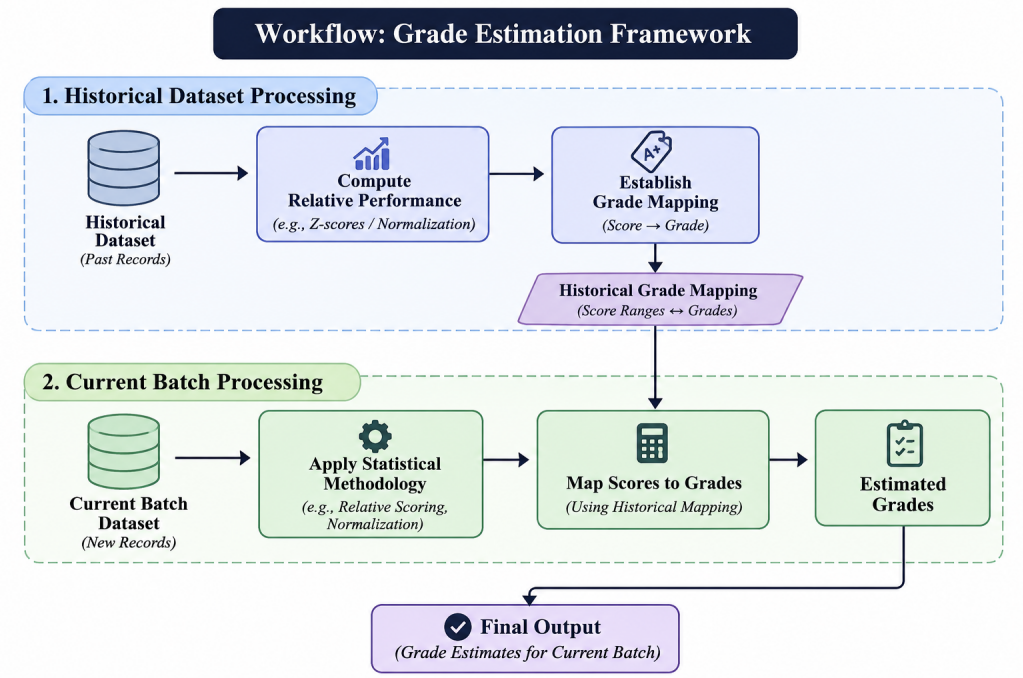


Figure 6.1: Overall workflow of the Student Performance Analytics & Prediction System.

6.2 Algorithm Explanation

The prediction algorithm can be divided into two major phases.

Phase 1: Historical Data Processing

1. Load the historical student dataset.
2. Extract the relevant academic performance attribute.
3. Calculate the mean and standard deviation.
4. Calculate the Z-score for every historical student.
5. Group students according to their actual grades.
6. Calculate the representative Z-score for each grade.
7. Store the resulting grade-to-Z-score mapping.

Phase 2: Current Batch Prediction

1. Load the current batch dataset.
2. Extract the corresponding academic performance attribute.
3. Calculate the current batch mean and standard deviation.
4. Calculate the Z-score for every current student.
5. Compare each student's Z-score with the historical grade mapping.
6. Assign the grade corresponding to the closest representative Z-score.
7. Generate the predicted grade output.

6.3 Pseudocode

Algorithm 1: Historical Grade Mapping

```
Input: Historical dataset H

Calculate mean mu of performance values
Calculate standard deviation sigma

For each student i in H:
    Calculate Z[i] = (X[i] - mu) / sigma

For each grade g:
    Collect Z-scores of students with grade g
    Calculate average Z-score Z_mean[g]

Output: Grade-to-Z-score mapping
```

Algorithm 2: Current Batch Grade Prediction

```
Input: Current dataset C
       Historical grade mapping M

Calculate mean mu_current
Calculate standard deviation sigma_current

For each student i in C:
    Calculate Z[i] = (X[i] - mu_current) / sigma_current

    For each historical grade g:
        Calculate distance:
        D[g] = abs(Z[i] - M[g])

    Assign the grade with minimum distance

Output: Predicted grades
```

6.4 Flowchart

The following flowchart illustrates the major stages of the prediction process.

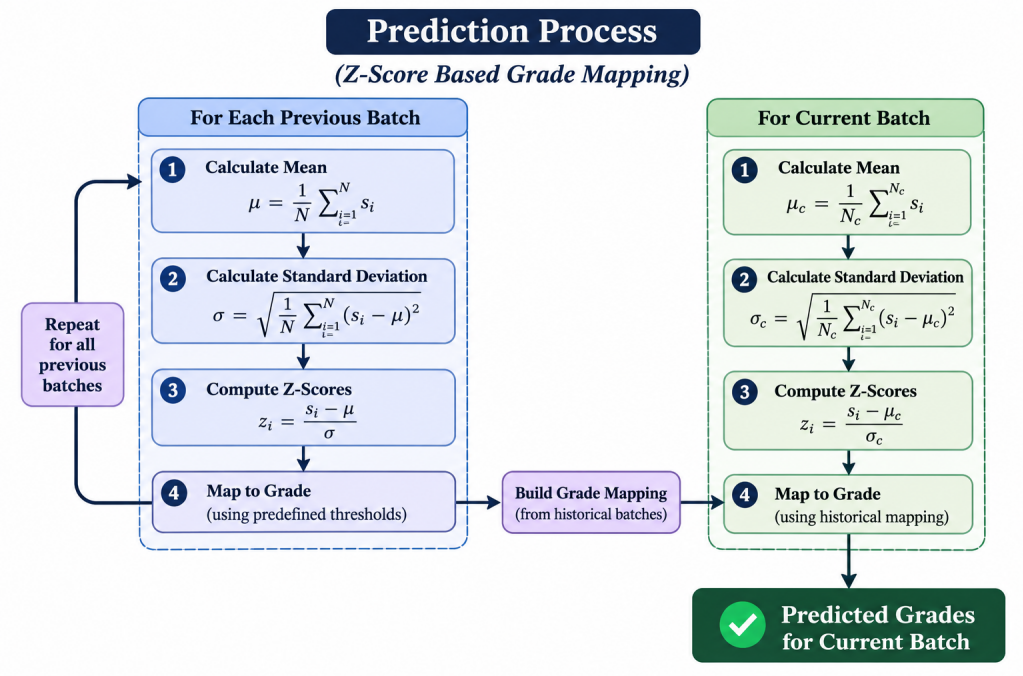


Figure 6.2: Flowchart illustrating historical grade mapping and current batch prediction.

Chapter 7

Implementation Details

7.1 System Architecture

The application is organized into components responsible for data processing, statistical analysis, visualization, and grade prediction.

The data-processing component handles the loading and preparation of academic datasets. The statistical component calculates the relevant measures, while the visualization component presents the results graphically.

The prediction component uses historical academic information to construct the grade mapping and estimate grades for current students.



Figure 7.1: System architecture of the proposed application.

7.2 Module-wise Implementation

The application is divided into logical modules to improve organization and maintainability.

Data Processing Module

Responsible for importing CSV datasets, cleaning records, and preparing data for further operations.

Statistical Analysis Module

Responsible for calculating statistical measures such as mean, median, standard deviation, and other relevant summaries.

Visualization Module

Responsible for generating graphical representations of student performance and statistical distributions.

Prediction Module

Responsible for calculating relative performance scores, constructing the historical grade mapping, and estimating current batch grades.

[**TO BE FILLED: Add actual module names and explain their specific responsibilities.**]

7.3 Technologies and Libraries

The project uses Python as its primary programming language.

Pandas is used for reading and manipulating tabular academic datasets. NumPy supports numerical and statistical computations, while Matplotlib is used to generate graphical visualizations.

Object-oriented programming principles are used to organize the application where applicable. Bash scripting and Unix utilities support relevant execution and data-processing tasks.

7.4 Object-Oriented Design

Object-oriented programming provides a structured way to organize the application into classes and methods.

The system's responsibilities can be separated into classes for dataset handling, statistical analysis, visualization, and prediction, depending on the actual implementation.

This organization helps separate different functionalities and makes the application easier to maintain and extend.

[**TO BE FILLED: Describe the actual classes, attributes, methods, and relationships implemented in your project.**]

7.5 Shell Scripting and Unix Utilities

Bash scripting and Unix utilities are used to support the project workflow.

Shell scripts can automate repetitive execution tasks and simplify the process of running the application in a Unix/Linux environment.

[TO BE FILLED: Describe the actual scripts and Unix commands used in your implementation.]

Chapter 8

Statistical Analysis and Visualizations

This section presents the statistical observations obtained from the academic datasets. Visualizations are used to communicate distributions, relationships, and trends that may not be immediately apparent from raw numerical records.

8.1 Descriptive Statistical Analysis

Descriptive statistics provide a summary of the academic performance data.

The mean represents the average performance, while the median identifies the central observation when records are arranged in ascending order. Standard deviation measures the spread of marks around the mean.

Minimum and maximum values provide information about the range of observed performance.

These measures help establish an initial understanding of the dataset before applying the prediction methodology.

Table 8.1: Summary of descriptive statistics.

Statistical Measure	**Value**
Mean	68.5
Median	70
Standard Deviation	14.2
Minimum	32
Maximum	98

8.2 Marks Distribution Analysis

A histogram is used to visualize the distribution of student marks. It divides the observed marks into intervals and displays the number of students falling within each interval.

This visualization helps identify the concentration of student performance and whether the distribution is approximately symmetric or skewed.

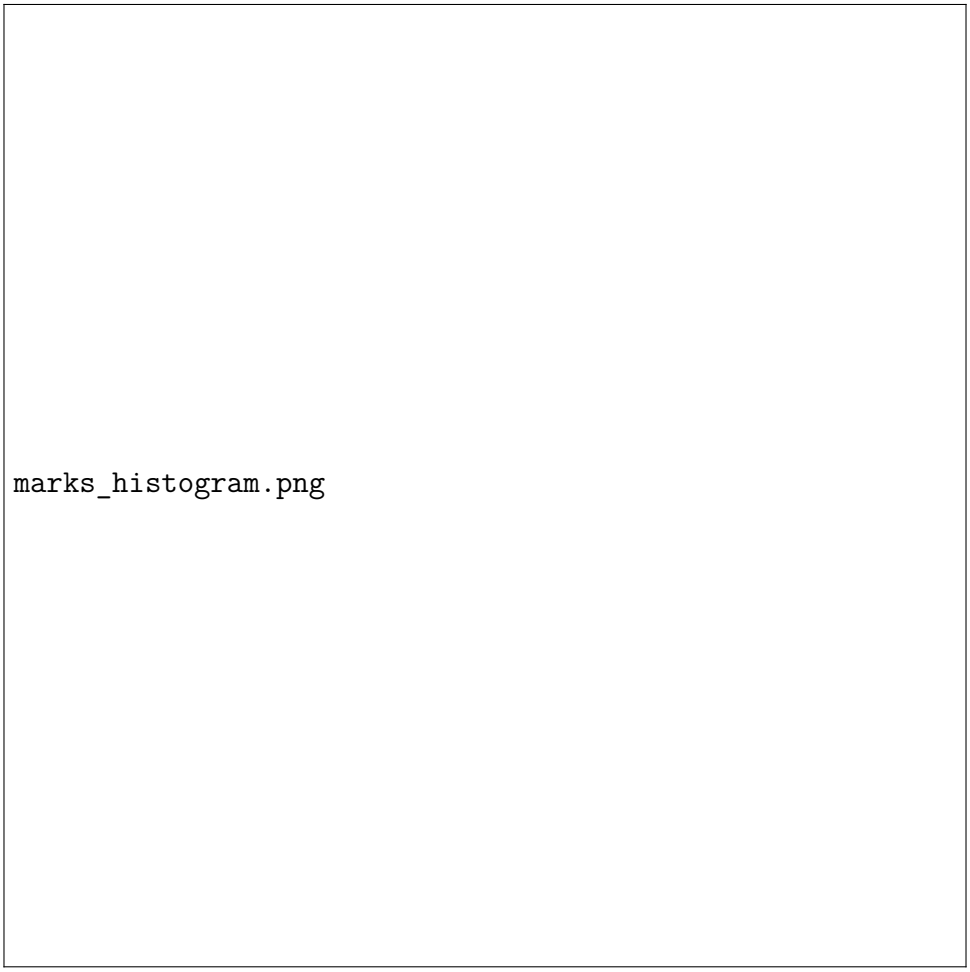


Figure 8.1: Distribution of student examination marks.

8.3 Historical Grade Distribution

The historical grade distribution represents the number of students receiving each grade category.

A bar chart can be used to compare the frequency of different grades and identify which grade categories occur most frequently.

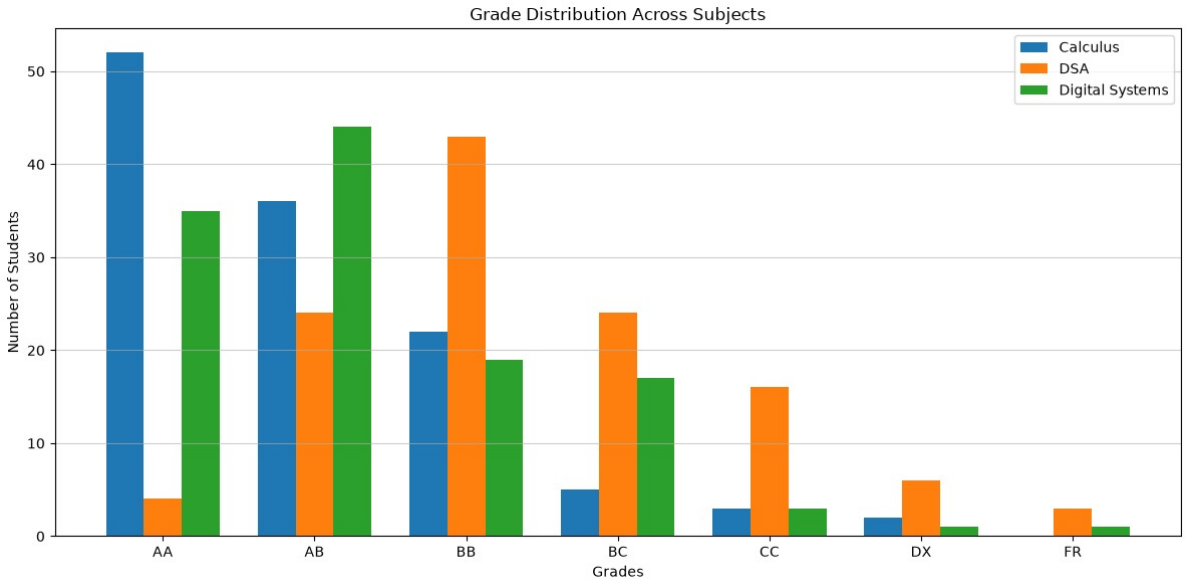


Figure 8.2: Distribution of grades in the historical dataset.

The distribution provides useful context for understanding the historical grading pattern and the number of observations available for each grade category.

8.4 Attendance and Academic Performance

Attendance is another academic attribute that may provide information about student performance.

The relationship between attendance and examination marks can be examined using a scatter plot. Each point represents a student, with attendance on one axis and examination marks on the other.

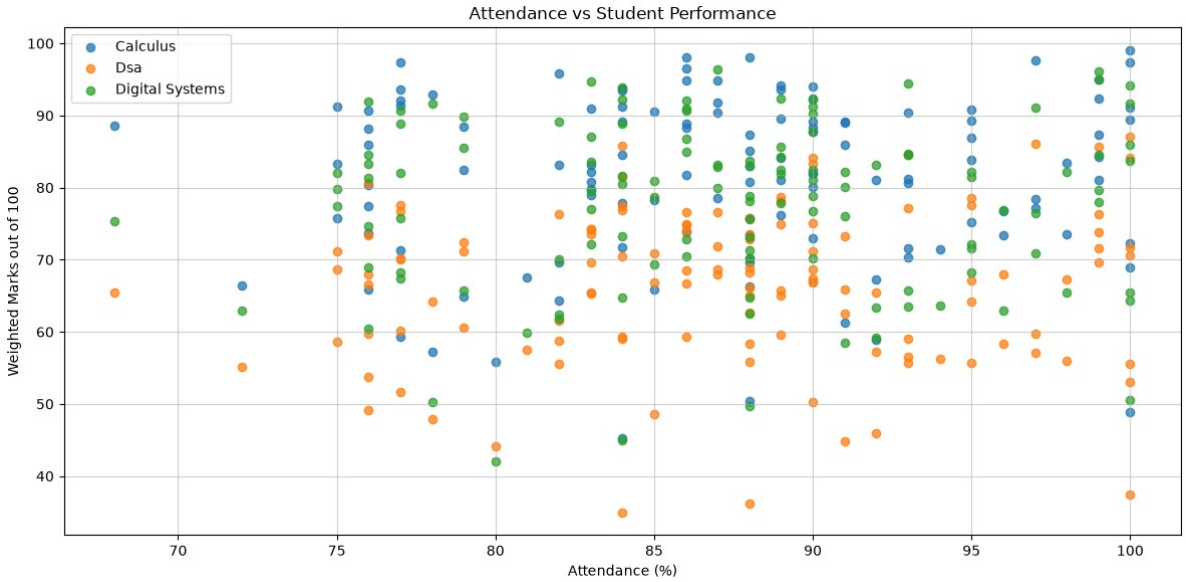


Figure 8.3: Relationship between student attendance and examination marks.

8.5 Relative Performance Analysis

Relative performance analysis examines student performance after accounting for the overall batch distribution.

The Z-score distribution provides an overview of how student performance is positioned relative to the batch average.

The visualization can compare historical grades with their corresponding Z-scores.

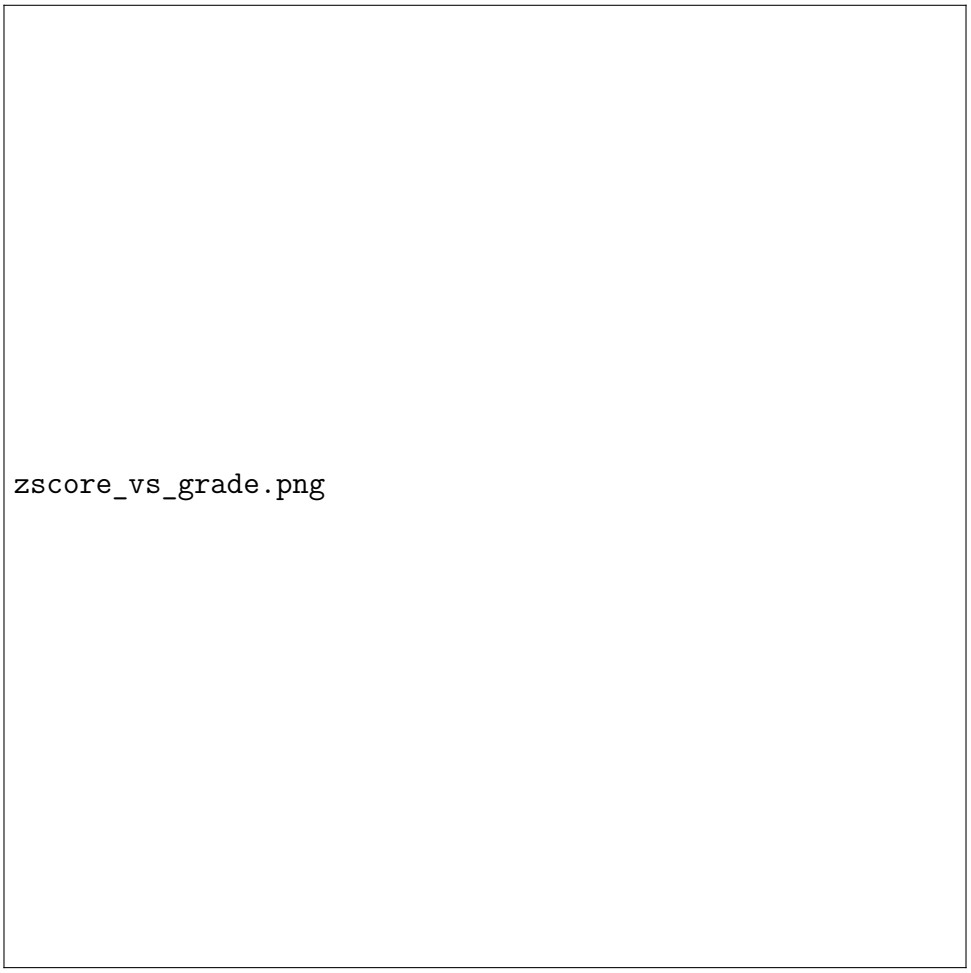


Figure 8.4: Relationship between historical grades and relative performance.

These visualizations help explain how relative performance differs across students and how the historical grade categories are distributed with respect to Z-scores.

Chapter 9

Evaluation

Validation is performed to examine whether the proposed prediction methodology can estimate grades for students whose actual grades are already known but were not used to construct the historical grade mapping.

This is important because evaluating predictions on the same records used to build the mapping may produce misleading results.

9.1 Evaluation Metrics

The performance of the prediction algorithm can be evaluated using suitable classification metrics.

Accuracy

Accuracy represents the proportion of correctly predicted grades among all evaluated records.

$$Accuracy = \frac{\text{Number of Correct Predictions}}{\text{Total Number of Predictions}} \tag{9.1}$$

Precision

Precision measures the proportion of predictions assigned to a particular grade that are correct.

$$Precision = \frac{TP}{TP + FP} \tag{9.2}$$

9.2 Error Analysis

Error analysis examines the predictions that differ from the actual grades.

Some students may receive estimated grades different from their actual awarded grades because of variations in batch performance, grade distributions, examination difficulty, or the limitations of representing an entire grade category using a single average Z-score.

Analysing these errors helps identify the limitations of the proposed methodology and possible areas for improvement.

9.3 Limitations

The proposed approach has certain limitations.

First, the method relies on historical academic records to establish the relationship between relative performance and awarded grades. If grading policies or examination patterns change significantly between batches, the historical mapping may become less representative.

Second, representing each grade using a single average Z-score may not fully capture the variation of student performance within that grade category.

Third, Z-score normalization can be affected by the distribution of marks and the presence of extreme observations.

Finally, the prediction results depend on the quality and representativeness of the available historical dataset.

These limitations should be considered when interpreting the estimated grades.

Chapter 10

Conclusion and Future Scope

10.1 Conclusion

The Student Performance Analytics & Prediction System provides an integrated approach to analysing academic performance and estimating student grades using historical academic information.

The application processes student records, performs statistical calculations, and generates visualizations to identify performance patterns and trends.

The prediction component uses Z-score-based normalization to represent student performance relative to their batch. Historical grade information is used to construct a reference mapping, which is subsequently applied to estimate grades for students in the current batch.

The project demonstrates how statistical techniques and data-processing tools can be combined to develop an academic performance analysis and prediction application.

The validation process provides a means of evaluating the effectiveness of the proposed methodology by comparing estimated grades against actual historical grades.

10.2 Future Scope

The proposed system can be extended in several ways.

Additional academic attributes, such as assignment performance, attendance, and examination components, may be incorporated into the prediction methodology to explore whether they improve grade estimation.

More historical datasets from different batches may also be used to establish a more representative relationship between relative performance and awarded grades.

Alternative statistical and machine-learning approaches could be explored and compared with the proposed Z-score-based method.

Further improvements may include better handling of outliers, analysis of grade-level distributions, and more comprehensive validation strategies.

These extensions could improve the flexibility and reliability of the system.

Chapter 11

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2. Pandas Documentation. https://pandas.pydata.org/docs/
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4. Matplotlib Documentation. https://matplotlib.org/stable/